

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ A 7
 ♥ 10 9 5
 ♦ K Q J 10 8 4
 ♣ Q 2

♠ J 10 8 6

♥ K Q 4

♦ A 7

♣ A 9 8 5

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 4 3 2

♥ 8 6 2

♦ 5 2

♣ J 10 6 4 3

♠ K Q 9 5

♥ A J 7 3

♦ 9 6 3

♣ K 7

West	North	East	South
1 ♦	Dbl	Pass	2 ♦
3 ♦	3 ♠	Pass	4 ♠
All Pass			
4 ♠ by North			
Lead: ♦ 5			

The bidding has been as shown.

You'd really like to have 4-card support for both Majors when you double a Minor. But it's not a requirement. So you double and hear partner respond 2 ♦. West then chips in with 3 ♦. What now?

Don't let West's bid bother you, he's just trying to push the envelope. You have a good hand and partner's bid shows 12+ points and is forcing to game. Now you have to find the right game, and the best way to start is by showing a 4-card Major suit. You bid 3 ♠.

That was what partner needed to hear, he bids 4 ♠.

Board 2

South Deals

N-S Vul

♠ 9 5
♥ K Q 10 3
♦ A 10 5 4
♣ A 9 6

♠ J 3
♥ 9 6 5
♦ K Q 2
♣ J 10 8 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 8 6
♥ 7 4 2
♦ 9 8 3
♣ K 7 5

♠ K 10 7 4 2
♥ A J 8
♦ J 7 6
♣ Q 3

West	North	East	South
			1 ♠
Dbl	Pass	1NT	
All Pass			
1NT by East			
Lead: ♦ 7			

The bidding has been as shown.

The minimum requirements for a Takeout Double are 12 points, no more than two of Opener's suit, and at least 3-cards in the other suits. You just squeak by so you double. Partner says 1NT and it is your bid again.

With no suit fit you can't even count a point for your doubleton so you have just 13 HCP. Partner's bid shows 8-10 so you waste no time in passing. Don't worry about the ♠s, partner says he has them covered.

Board 3

West Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K J 7 4 2

♥ A J 8 5

♦ K 7 2

♣ J

♠ 9 5

♥ K Q 10 3

♦ A J 10 5

♣ A K 6

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A Q 8 6

♥ 7 4 2

♦ Q 8 3

♣ Q 7 5

♠ 10 3

♥ 9 6

♦ 9 6 4

♣ 10 9 8 4 3 2

West

1 ♠

Pass

All Pass

3NT by South

Lead: ♣J

North

Dbl

3NT

East

Pass

South

1NT

The bidding has been as shown.

Partner is showing you 8-10 points and no 4-card ♥ suit.

With no Major fit you are happy to play in notrump, knowing partner can stop their suit. Partner's 8-10 points added to your 17 is a probable game so you bid 3NT.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ K 8

♥ A K Q 10 7 3

♦ A 7 5

♣ 9 4

♠ 10 5

♥ J 8

♦ Q 8 3 2

♣ J 10 7 3 2



♠ 7 6 4 3

♥ 9 6 2

♦ 9 4

♣ A K 8 6

♠ A Q J 9 2

♥ 5 4

♦ K J 10 6

♣ Q 5

The bidding has been as shown.

You have 16 HCP and two more points for the fifth and sixth ♥s. That is too strong for a simple overcall. Instead you double. Partner responds 2♣.

You bid 2♥, describing your hand as a 1-suited hand, too strong to merely overcall. Partner bids the ♥ game and you pass.

West	North	East	South
			1♠
Dbl	Pass	2♣	Pass
2♥	Pass	4♥	
All Pass			
4♥ by West			
Lead: ♠10			

Board 5

West Deals

None Vul

♠ K Q 2
 ♥ A 10 9 8
 ♦ 9 6 4
 ♣ K 8 3

♠ 7 4

♥ J 5

♦ K 8 7 3 2

♣ Q 7 6 2



♠ J 10 9 6 3

♥ 6 4 2

♦ Q

♣ A J 10 5

♠ A 8 5

♥ K Q 7 3

♦ A J 10 5

♣ 9 4

West	North	East	South
1 ♣	Pass	1 ♠	Dbl
Pass	2 ♦		
All Pass			
2 ♦ by North			
Lead: ♠ J			

The bidding has been as shown.

You should double. This is a special case of the Takeout Double, where the opponents have already bid two suits before it gets to you. Since they apparently have at least 20 points, you should have a solid hand with at least 4-4 in the two unbid suits. A hand just like this one.

Partner bids 2 ♦. What do you say next?

Just pass. This is obviously a fight for the partscore and you have the advantage because you have found a fit. However, you suspect partner is quite weak.